

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<thought>

To solve this problem , we need to understand the symptoms described and match them with the most appropriate diagnosis . The patient talks about persistent sadness for a long time , feeling hopeless , and having suicidal thoughts , which are indicative of major depressive disorder (MDD). The worsening of suicidal ideation and the feeling of being "cursed" also point towards a more severe form of depression .

</thought>

< answer >

A . The patient is at risk for double depression .</answer>

<thought>

The term "double depression" usually refers to a patient experiencing a second episode of depression after a first episode , but it's not a standard diagnostic term . However , given the context , the patient 's symptoms are more aligned with the persistent depressive disorder , which is a long-standing form of depression .

</thought>

< answer >

C . The patient is likely to show anhedonia .</answer>

